TSA Mission & Modernization Delivery (MMD) – Solicitation Q&A Responses – Set 2 061226

1. Period of Performance and Option Years

Q: Please confirm the governing period of performance, the number of option periods, and the start and end dates for each ordering period.
A: The period of performance is a base period of 12 months, followed by two 12-month option periods, for a total possible period of 36 months. The anticipated start date is July 15, 2026, but this is subject to change prior to award.

2. CLIN Structure and Mapping

Q: Please provide an authoritative crosswalk between the Section II pricing CLINs and the PWS CLIN/task scope.
A: The CLIN structure in the solicitation aligns with the PWS as follows:

- **CLIN 0001:** Program Management (PWS Section 4.1)
- **CLIN 0002:** Mission Systems: Screening – Transportation Security Equipment (TSE) (PWS Section 4.2)
- **CLIN 0003:** Mission Systems: Domain Awareness, Counter Terrorism (SLE), Incident Management, Cybersecurity Management Delivery (PWS Section 4.3)
- **CLIN 0004:** Transportation Screening Equipment (TSE) Support (see PWS Section 4.2 and related deliverables)
- **CLIN 0005:** Ins-Pi Platform Provisioning and User/Software Management (PWS Section 4.3.4 and Section 3.0, Item 7)
- **CLIN 0006:** Travel (see PWS Section 10.0)
- **CLIN 0007:** Contract Access Fee (CAF)
  Option year CLINs (1001–1007, 2001–2007) follow the same structure for each option period. Refer to PWS Section 4.0 for detailed task alignment.

3. Transition/Phase-In and Fitness Determination

Q: Will there be a separate transition-in phase, and what is the process for fitness determination?
A: There will not be a separate transition-in phase. Contractors are encouraged to pre-screen candidates using internal processes that have a high propensity to succeed through the government badging and PIV issuance process. The screening process generally takes up to 60 days; however, the government reserves the right to conduct the screening process for a longer period if necessary. The intended start date is July 15, 2026, but this is subject to change prior to award. Contractors are expected to propose technical approaches that can be executed starting day one of the period of performance.

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4. Price Ceilings and CLIN Inclusion

Q: Are the $3,370,000 base year cap and $9,990,000 overall cap inclusive of all CLINs?
A: Yes. The $3,370,000 base year cap and $9,990,000 overall cap are inclusive of all costs for the base and two option periods, including Ins-Pi licensing, travel, and the Contract Access Fee (CAF).

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5. Pricing Methodology and Template

Q: Will a government pricing template be provided, and how should CLINs be structured?
A: No government pricing template will be provided. Offerors must submit their own Excel pricing workbook in accordance with the solicitation instructions. Labor-based CLINs must be proposed as firm fixed price per month. Licensing CLINs (e.g., Ins-Pi) should be proposed as firm fixed price per “each” and may be billed and paid at the start of performance. All pricing must map to GSA STARS III labor categories, rates, and any applicable discounts.

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6. STARS III Labor Rates and Escalation

Q: Which STARS III labor rates apply, and will TSA provide a skill mix or level of effort?
A: Offerors must use the STARS III labor rates and escalation that correspond to the proposed period of performance for this task order. Offerors are responsible for proposing their own skill mix and level of effort to support the firm fixed price for each CLIN. TSA will not provide a prescribed skill mix or level of effort.

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7. Other Direct Costs (ODCs) and CAF

Q: How should Ins-Pi licensing and CAF be priced?
A: Ins-Pi licensing should be proposed as an ODC with a clear price build-up and consistent with Section III - LIMITATIONS ON OTHER DIRECT COSTS (ODC) AND INDIRECT RATE

APPLICATION. The STARS III CAF is 0.75 percent and must be proposed as a separate CLIN each year, calculated as 0.75% of all CLINs.

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8. Travel Pricing

Q: How should travel be priced and approved?
A: Travel is cost reimbursable and subject to a ceiling of $50k per year. All travel must comply with GSA per diem rates and the Federal Travel Regulation. Travel must be approved in advance by the COR or CO. Travel costs incurred without prior approval will not be reimbursed.

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9. CLIN Scope and Performance Requirements

Q: Please clarify the intended scope and performance requirements for all CLINs.
A: See PWS Sections 4.1–4.3 for detailed scope by CLIN. CLIN 0001 covers program management; CLIN 0002 covers TSE mission architecture; CLIN 0003 covers domain awareness, counterterrorism, incident management, and cybersecurity. CLIN 0004–0005 are for TSE support and Ins-Pi provisioning, respectively.

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10. Key Personnel, Labor Mix, and Minimum Qualifications

Q: Are there any required Key Personnel or minimum qualifications?
A: The solicitation does not designate specific Key Personnel or minimum qualifications. Offerors should propose personnel with the expertise necessary to fulfill the requirements in the PWS, including technical, subject matter, and tool-specific expertise.

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11. Level of Effort and Staffing

Q: Will TSA provide a minimum staffing level or historical staffing data?
A: TSA will not provide a minimum staffing level or skill mix. Offerors are to propose their own staffing approach and level of effort, as required by the PWS.

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12. Deliverables Table and Historical Workload

Q: Is a deliverables table required, and will historical workload data be provided?
A: See PWS Section 5.2 for a detailed list of deliverables and estimated frequencies. The

approach to providing the work listed in the deliverables table is required as part of the proposal and will be incorporated into the contract. Historical workload data is not provided.

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13. Transition-In/Out and Access to Existing Documentation

Q: Will incumbent documentation and artifacts be provided to the awardee?
A: All documentation created under the contract is government-owned and will be made available to the awardee. Access to repositories, SOPs, project plans, and artifacts will be provided at kickoff.

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14. Incumbent Contractor and Historical Information

Q: Who is the incumbent contractor, and what is the current staffing?
A: This is a follow-on to Task Order 70T03020F6NCIO076. The solicitation does not specify the incumbent contractor or current staffing levels. The contract is now set aside for GSA 8(a) STARS III holders.

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15. Scope Changes from Incumbent

Q: Have the scope, tasks, or deliverables changed from the prior contract?
A: Offerors should review the PWS for current requirements. Any significant changes from the prior contract are reflected in the revised PWS and CLIN structure.

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16. Organizational Conflict of Interest

Q: Are there any known organizational conflicts of interest?
A: No known organizational conflicts of interest are identified in the solicitation. Offerors should disclose any potential conflicts as required by FAR.

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17. Ins-Pi/YouDesign Licensing and Platform Support

Q: Does TSA currently hold any Ins-Pi or YouDesign licenses?
A: Offerors should propose as if a new subscription is required unless otherwise amended. The contractor must provide a production instance of Ins-Pi with the specified licenses and support as detailed in the PWS.

18. Integration and Data Migration

Q: Will existing repository data and admin access be provided for integration?
A: Ins-Pi must be integrated with TSA's ServiceNow platform and other data sources as described in the PWS. Existing repository data and administrative access will be provided as needed for migration and integration.

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19. System Administration and ATO Support

Q: Is the contractor responsible for full system administration and ATO documentation?
A: Yes. The contractor is responsible for system administration, ATO documentation, upgrades, patching, and troubleshooting for Ins-Pi and related tools (see PWS 4.3.4).

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20. Proven Optics and TBM Tools

Q: Is Proven Optics currently deployed within TSA and expected to be supported?
A: Proven Optics is referenced as a tool in use (PWS 4.3.2). The contractor is expected to support TBM and FITARA implementation, including use of Proven Optics and ServiceNow.

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21. Accessibility Conformance (Section 508)

Q: Is an Accessibility Conformance Report (VPAT) required with the proposal?
A: Section 508 compliance is required for all ICT deliverables (PWS Section 11.0). An Accessibility Conformance Report (VPAT 2.2 or successor) may be requested by the government for proposed upgrades, substitutions, or replacements.

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22. On-Site vs. Remote Work

Q: What percentage of work is anticipated to be performed onsite versus remotely?
A: The primary place of performance is Springfield, VA (PWS 10.0). The PWS does not specify required on-site vs. remote ratios; offerors should propose an approach that meets the requirements. Remote work is permitted unless otherwise specified for particular tasks.

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23. Travel Requirements

Q: Are there recurring travel requirements beyond TSE support?
A: Travel is anticipated for TSE support and other CONUS locations, estimated at 3–6 trips per year, 3–5 days each (PWS 10.0). Additional recurring travel is not specified.

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24. Proposal Formatting, Page Limits, and Attachments

Q: What counts against the 15-page Volume I limit?
A: Volume I is limited to 15 pages, excluding standard forms, title page, table of contents, and acronym list. All other narrative and supporting content counts toward the page limit unless explicitly excluded. Font size must be 11 point or higher. The layout must be portrait orientation.

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25. Technical Approach Content

Q: Should the Technical Approach include staffing, labor mix, and past performance?
A: The Technical Approach should address how the offeror will accomplish the requirements of the PWS. Inclusion of staffing and labor mix is at the offeror's discretion. Past performance will not be evaluated.

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26. Evaluation Factors, Confidence Ratings, and Responsiveness

Q: How will the Government evaluate confidence in the Technical Approach, and how will price and responsiveness be considered?

A:
The Government will evaluate each Offeror's Technical Approach and assign one of the following confidence ratings:

- **High Confidence:** The Government has a thorough understanding of the Offeror's technical approach and a high degree of confidence that the Offeror will successfully, effectively, and efficiently perform all requirements. The approach contains no significant weaknesses. It may have strengths. There is no evaluated risk of unsuccessful performance.
- **Some Confidence:** The Government has a reasonable understanding of the Offeror's technical approach and some confidence that the Offeror will successfully perform the requirements. The approach has minor weaknesses, but no significant weaknesses. The minor weaknesses may impact performance, but are not expected to prevent successful contract execution.

- **Low Confidence:** The Government has significant concerns regarding the Offeror's technical approach and has identified significant weaknesses in the proposal. The approach presents a significant risk of unsuccessful performance.
- **No Confidence:** The Government has no confidence that the Offeror will be able to successfully perform the requirements. The proposal contains significant weaknesses or deficiencies such that successful performance is highly unlikely. Proposals rated "No Confidence" will be ineligible for award.

Non-Responsive Quotes:
A quote may be deemed non-responsive and removed from further evaluation if it fails to meet the following requirements:

- **General Non-Responsiveness:** Fails to comply with solicitation instructions, omits required information, or does not address the requirements of the solicitation and PWS.
- **Technical Non-Responsiveness:** Does not provide a clear, complete, and feasible approach to meeting the requirements of the PWS, or fails to address material requirements. Technical proposals that receive a "No Confidence" rating will be considered non-responsive.
- **Price Non-Responsiveness:** Price proposal is incomplete, fails to provide required pricing information, does not comply with pricing instructions, or proposes prices that are not fair and reasonable or not in accordance with GSA STARS III contract rates.

Non-responsive quotes may be removed from the evaluation and found ineligible for award.

Price Evaluation:
Price will not be assigned a confidence rating. The Government will evaluate price proposals to determine if the prices are fair and reasonable, balanced, and in accordance with GSA STARS III contract rates and applicable discounts. The Government will also review the overall competition to determine if adequate price competition exists for this solicitation.

Discussions and Negotiations:
Contractors should provide their best technical approach and price up front, without the expectation of clarifications, exchanges, or discussions. The Government reserves the right to negotiate with the best suited quoter, defined as the quoter whose proposal represents the best value to the Government. If negotiations are not successful with the best suited quoter, the Government reserves the right to negotiate with the next best suited quoter, and so forth.

Relative Importance:
As stated in the solicitation, the Technical Approach (confidence rating) is significantly more important than price. However, as confidence ratings among Offerors become more similar, price will become increasingly important in the best value determination.

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27. Quality Assurance and SLAs

Q: What are the required SLAs for application issue resolution?
A: See PWS Section 8.0 for QASP. Acceptable quality levels and metrics are defined, but specific SLA timeframes for issue resolution are not detailed. Offerors may propose severity tiers and response times in their Quality Assurance Plan for government acceptance.

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28. FAR Clauses and Proposal Requirements

Q: Which FAR clauses apply, and how should offerors comply?
A: FAR 52.212-4 and 52.212-5 are incorporated by reference. Full text is available at www.acquisition.gov. Offerors must comply with all referenced clauses.

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29. Standard Forms Submission

Q: Where should the SF 1449 and any SF 30s be submitted?
A: The SF 1449 and any SF 30s must be completed and submitted as part of the offer. Offerors may include them in Volume I.

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30. Security Clearances and Suitability

Q: Are any specific clearances required for personnel?
A: All contractor personnel must undergo a TSA fitness determination (see TSA RQMTS, Contractor Personnel Access). Public trust is required; contractor personnel must have a SECRET or higher clearance or be eligible for an interim SECRET clearance. Privileged-user access requires biennial screening.

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31. Sensitive Security Information (SSI) Handling

Q: Are there special requirements for handling SSI?
A: SSI handling and training requirements are detailed in TSA RQMTS. All personnel with access to SSI must sign NDAs and complete annual SSI Awareness Training.

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32. Questions and Amendments

Q: How will questions and amendments be handled?
A: Questions are due by the date specified in the solicitation (see eBuy posting). Answers and amendments will be posted via GSA eBuy.